Problem–Solution Fit Template

Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow

1. Purpose

This template checks whether the proposed Incident Lifecycle Automation solution addresses a meaningful incident-management problem and whether the proposed approach fits the needs of intended users. Complete the template using stakeholder feedback and evidence from the project environment.

2. Problem summary

Potential problem: incident handling may become inconsistent or delayed when categorisation, prioritisation, assignment, status communication, knowledge reuse, and resolution documentation depend on manual steps.

Problem statement: How might ServiceNow support a consistent, traceable incident lifecycle from incident creation to resolution and closure while reducing repetitive manual effort?

3. Target users and their needs

End users need a clear way to report incidents and understand permitted status updates.

Service desk agents need consistent incident information, clear priorities, and appropriate assignment.

Technical support teams need useful diagnostic details and accessible knowledge articles.

Process owners need reliable records to review lifecycle handling and resolution information.

4. Proposed solution hypothesis

If selected ServiceNow capabilities—such as Incident Management, Flow Designer, Business Rules, Knowledge Management, and appropriate access controls—are configured to support the agreed process, then incident handling may become more consistent and easier to track. This is a hypothesis to validate, not a claim of measured improvement.

5. Problem–solution fit matrix

For each problem, record the user affected, proposed feature or process change, expected benefit, evidence needed, and validation result.

6. Assumptions to validate

Users can access the approved incident submission channel.

Required incident fields and lifecycle states can be configured in the available ServiceNow instance.

The project team has permission to configure and test the selected features.

Knowledge articles are available or can be represented with sample content for demonstration.

Any notifications, assignment automation, or change links are included only if they are configured and tested.

7. Validation plan

Interview or consult representative users and support agents.

Walk through sample incident scenarios in a development or training instance.

Check whether users can submit, track, and understand an incident using the proposed process.

Record issues, feedback, and changes required before finalising the design.

8. Decision record

Problem validated? Yes / No / Partially

Solution fit: Strong / Moderate / Needs revision

Evidence reviewe

Changes require

Reviewed by / dat

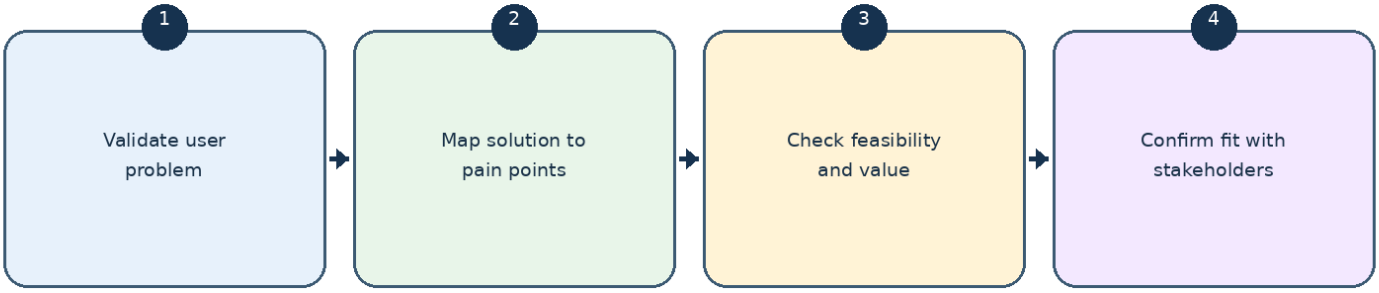
Problem–solution fit matrix

Problem / need	Affected user	Proposed solution	Expected benefit	Evidence / status
Slow manual triage	Callers and service desk agents	Auto-categorize and calculate priority using impact and urgency	Faster, more consistent triage	Proposed; validate with stakeholders
Incidents reach the wrong team	Service desk and resolver groups	Route by category and subcategory with Flow Designer	Reduced reassignment and delay	Proposed; verify in test instance
SLA deadlines are missed	Incident manager and assignees	Send threshold warnings and breach escalations	Earlier intervention and visibility	Proposed; measure during testing
Incomplete resolution records	Agents and callers	Require resolution code and notes before resolving	Better auditability and reporting	Proposed; test Business Rules
Repeated incidents take time to diagnose	Agents and knowledge managers	Suggest related Knowledge articles	Faster diagnosis and reuse of fixes	Proposed; validate article relevance
Change-related incidents lack coordination	Agents and change managers	Link Change Requests and manage On Hold state	Clearer dependency tracking	Proposed; validate workflow

Process Diagram

Problem Solution Fit Template

Incident Lifecycle Automation • Process diagram



Expected output: a traceable, testable process with clear ownership and documented outcomes.